

JACOB COOK

Cyber Defense Response Analyst II | Incident Response & Threat Hunting | SIEM · Python · MITRE ATT&CK · Multi-Cloud

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Detail-driven security professional with the kind of researcher mindset that gets lost in the one log entry that doesn't belong. Hands-on building Wazuh SIEM detections, authoring Sigma rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, and writing Python automation that calls security tool APIs. Comfortable driving incident response from triage to documented root cause and contributing to runbooks. CompTIA-certified across four disciplines (Security+, CySA+, PenTest+, SecurityX); BS Computer Science; MS Cybersecurity in progress.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

DFIR & Threat Hunting: Incident Response Lifecycle (triage → remediation), Misconfiguration & Detection-Gap Hunting, Log/Artifact Timeline Analysis, Root Cause Analysis, Tabletop Exercise Participation, Runbook & Playbook Authoring
SIEM & Detection: Wazuh SIEM (build & admin), Sigma Rule Authoring, MITRE ATT&CK, Microsoft Sentinel (familiar), KQL/SPL (familiar), Detection Tuning, IOC Analysis
Automation & Scripting: Python (Pandas, REST APIs, FastAPI), Bash, SQL, Webhook Playbooks, AI-Assisted Analysis
Cloud & Identity: Azure / Entra ID, AWS labs, Okta, SSO / RBAC, Terraform

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

- Stryker / Intune Detection Pack: Detection-as-Code** 2026
- Authored 6 Sigma-format detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK that eliminated 100% of false positives in a 100-event simulation, with documented timeline analysis and IOC trail per detected event.
 - Documented 3 benign scenarios per rule (18 total) so analysts can drive incidents to clean root cause without rabbit-hole rework on known-good activity.
 - Verification: 43 passing pytest cases in repo (tests/test_rules.py).
- Blue Team SOC Monitoring Lab: Wazuh SIEM** 2026
- Built full Wazuh stack from scratch — log ingestion, normalization, alert rules — and validated 12 detection patterns against 242 simulated events with 100% precision after tuning, the same threat-hunt & detection-gap discipline a CDR Analyst II applies.
 - Identified and tuned out 79 benign-only matches with documented hunt rationale — the kind of misconfiguration-and-anomaly hunt CME's role centers on.
 - Verification: 19 passing pytest cases in repo (tests/test_detection_accuracy.py).
- SOAR-lite: Incident Response Orchestrator** 2026
- Used Python and REST APIs to integrate security tools and automate response workflows — webhook ingestion, playbook routing, IP blocking, Slack notification, and incident write-up — reducing triage time by over 60% in lab testing.
 - Documented runbook coverage and end-to-end handoff path that mirrors the playbook-authoring expectations of a CDR Analyst II.
 - Verification: 10 passing pytest cases in repo (tests/test_orchestrator.py).
- Phishing Analysis Lab** 2026
- Triageed 5 phishing samples end-to-end with timeline reconstruction, IOC extraction, and attacker infrastructure mapping — 100% accurate verdicts against ground truth.
 - Delivered structured incident summaries usable both for executive briefing and analyst follow-up.
- G3-GPT: Industry-Sponsored Enterprise AI Platform (Team of 6)** 2024
- Engineered RBAC and Azure AD SSO on a production AI platform that enabled executive-level adoption with zero critical security findings at delivery.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Target Distribution Center | Operations Engineer: Systems Monitoring & Incident Response** 2019 - 2025
- Maintained 99.5% system uptime by tracking telemetry across automated infrastructure on rotating shifts — direct continuous-monitoring discipline transferable to global cyber defense operations.
 - Resolved 200+ anomalies through structured root cause analysis — the same researcher mindset CME's role rewards — reducing repeat incidents by an estimated 30%.
 - Reduced mean time to recovery by an estimated 20% via cross-team incident response coordination, escalation, and post-incident reporting.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- WGU | MS, Cybersecurity (In Progress)** Expected Oct 2026 · GPA 3.50
CSUS | BS, Computer Science Jan 2025 · GPA 3.50
CompTIA: Security+ · CySA+ · PenTest+ · SecurityX · CSIE (stackable)